9

My top 10(ish) players

I say Top 10(ish) because I included an extra guy, but kept him outside the Top 10. He's a bit of a nutter compared to the exulted company in this chapter, but certainly worthy of a mention. So … my Top 10(ish). A little weird, sure, but think of it as another of the little 'discrepancies' that are sprinkled throughout my life and career.

Adam Gilchrist

The thing I love about Adam Gilchrist is that, with him, it is always all or nothing, which is also the way in which he approaches his batting. Irrespective of what the situation in the game is, whether he is opening in a limited-overs game or coming in at seven in a Test match, he always has the same approach. Although some may think all Gilly wanted to do was slog, for him it was about playing positive cricket. Essentially batting is all about hitting a ball with a bat, which Gilly understood and executed, often with frightening ferocity. He always wanted to make the game move forward.

Even if Gilly was going through a bit of a lean spell – as in the 2005 Ashes series, when Freddie Flintoff seemed to have his number – he'd never doubt his ability or withdraw into his shell. Nope, Gilly would still be out there, trying to klap the ball over the top from the word go.

And when he was on song – which was most of the time – his hitting was sublime. I don't think anyone quite timed the ball like Gilly. His ability to pick up the length of the ball very early is a gift that helped him tremendously. I think that the Aussie wickets contributed to Gilly's approach, as the pitches don't seam much and the ball comes on quite nicely. All of the Aussies tend to hit through the line of the ball really well.